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PROJECT REPORT

On

FloodSense: Data-Driven Prediction for Safer Communities

Submitted to

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Master of Computer Applications

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CERTIFICATE

We, **B G Sai Gargya Savasya (12300353)**, **EZRA YALLEY (12419287)**, **Saurav kumar (12000014)** and **Anirban Das 12010102**, hereby declare that the work done by us on “**FloodSense: Data-Driven Prediction for Safer Communities**” under “**Dr. Geeta Sharma**” from **January 2025** to **May 2025** at Lovely professional University, Phagwara, Punjab, is a record of original work for the partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of the degree Master Of Computer Applications. The results embodied in this report have not been submitted to any other subject or university.

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INTRODUCTION

The Problem

Floods are the one of the most disastrous natural hazards that damage at social scale and economy of countries. Existing flood monitoring systems are not enough to explain the complicated water movements in flooded areas. The majority of currently available models either draw heavily on the past, or use a single environmental factor, including river discharge and rainfall, to predict floods. Although such techniques may produce some indication, such methods have their limitations in dynamic weather conditions and regions with short or scarce data.

One of the weaknesses of the present control of flood hazards would be to have integrated technology for monitoring purposes. Hydrologic variables including river water levels and soil moistures are commonly monitored independently of meteorologic variables such as wind and atmospheric pressure. Such compartmentalization means that the causes of flooding cannot be fully understood, and that EWSs do not provide timely and accurate warnings.

Current systems also rely on human intervention for data collection and analysis, which results in a delay in broadcasting important alerts. In most of the flood-prone areas, especially in developing countries, the required real-time monitoring infrastructure is either not there at all or not adequate. This means that there is little warning of imminent flooding and communities are defenseless.

In view of these challenges, there is a demand for a complete flood risk estimation framework capable of automatically cobbling together a range of environmental data sets and processing them on-the-fly and acting on pertinent early warning alerts. This gap is addressed in the proposed Autonomous IoT-Enabled Early Warning Framework, which integrates various sensing technologies with smart analytics to provide complete, rapid and efficient support for flood risk management.

CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION TO MACHINE LEARNING

1.1 About Flood Risk Prediction System

Flood is one of the most disastrous and catastrophic natural disasters in the world, which leads to significant human suffering, damage to infrastructure and economic losses annually. Such disastrous occurrences cause mass casualties, property damage, and loss of vital public services, as well as damaging economic effects on impacted localities. These events and their frequency and severity can, in turn, be traced to the exacerbating impact of climate change and the radical disruption of historical weather patterns around the world. Close Rainfall trends have been erratic and unpredictable, with some areas receiving record amounts of rain and others experiencing long periods of drought. Rivers rise and fall much faster than historical records would suggest and different soils even within quite small areas, can be saturated in differing amounts, for challenging conditions for traditional prediction methods to Analyse effectively.

Those changing environmental conditions have yielded an urgent requirement for an early reliable flood warning system, which can issue actionable warnings prior to disasters. The Flood Risk Prediction System being developed in this work fulfils this important requirement by combining state-of-the-art machine learning methods with a broad array of environmental and geographical variables. It handles multivariate data streams, looking for elusive patterns and correlations that a human or traditional statistics might fail to ferret out. From precipitation intensity to soil moisture to river gauge readings to topographical features and historical flooding, the system analyses these factors to provide early warning to possible flooding events.

The main objective of this prediction system is to provide important groups, such as government organizations, disaster management authorities, and a local community, with timely and accurate information so that they can take proactive actions rather than responding reactively. By making accurate forecasts with a useful lead time, the system enables emergency responders to get the word out about evacuations, put resources where they are most needed, and trigger flood control gates and barriers before waters rise. This proactive response has saved many lives, reduced the cost of disasters in terms of property loss, and mitigated the threat to infrastructure from flood-related damage. The system represents a transformative shift from traditional flood management approaches, which often rely on responding to floods after they've begun, to a preventative model that anticipates and mitigates flood impacts before they materialize.

1.2 Statement About the Problem

Conventional flood forecasting models face severe challenges under the background of climate change and frequent occurrence of various extreme weather conditions. These traditional methods rely on manual observations from field staff, historical trend analysis that assumes climate stationarity, and inflexible statistical models that do not easily account for non-linear relationships among environmental variables. Faced with sudden climatic changes, such as the so-called never-before-seen weather, such methods of course cannot work so well to give an accurate warning, with two possibilities that the warning is delayed so that it comes too late or too early.

The major drawback of traditional flood forecast systems is their lack of capability for real-time and multi-data stream processing and integration. The large and growing volumes of meteorological, hydrological, and geographic data made available through modern monitoring networks are impractical for human analysts to observe and interpret in real time. Statistical models, although useful for historical-based understanding, are not capable of addressing the intricate simultaneous role of these many components in flood processes including, among others, rainfall intensity, saturation of the soil, river fluvial system and the local topography.

Another major limitation is the inflexibility of traditional forecasting techniques. When new data sources (e.g., high-resolution satellite imagery, IoT sensor networks, social media signals) become available, traditional systems cannot seamlessly adapt to these new inputs without significant reconfiguration. And, as climate change disrupts the relationship between environmental drivers and flood outcomes, computer models that rely on historical trends serve as an ever-poorer guide to what lay ahead. This inability of learning and adapt is a weakness in flood management infrastructure.

Taking together, these limitations paint a picture of an urgent demand for a smart, automated, and dynamic forecasting system that exploits the benefits of machine learning models. Through its analysis of large amounts of real time and historic environmental data via advanced pattern recognition, the system will be able to detect very slight forerunners to floodings which can be missed with traditional means. Machine learning algorithms can adjust to more accurately predict trends as new data are recorded, the researchers say, avoiding the need for manual re-calibration as the heat increases. More importantly, such advanced algorithms are able to make predictions well in advance of conventional techniques, allowing precious additional time for a fully prepared response. That longer lead time can be the difference between an orderly evacuation and a chaotic emergency, between protecting infrastructure from storm surges and spending time and money afterward to repair the damage they cause.

1.3 Technologies and Tools Used

The combination of computational efficiency, analytical power and user accessibility leads to develop our Flood Risk Prediction System using an appropriate set of technologies. The fundamental programming language of the entire system is Python, due to its wonderful trade-off between simplicity, readability and the rich collection of libraries available. The clean syntax and straight forward structure of Python helped foster collaboration among team-members from both the technical and domain perspective, ranging from data-scientists all the way to hydrologists. More importantly, Python's dominance in the data science and machine learning communities ensures access to cutting-edge analytical tools and continuous improvements in computational capabilities.

Being key libraries in the data science ecosystem of Python, we made extensive use of Pandas and NumPy for data manipulation and preprocessing. Pandas offered powerful data structures and data manipulation operations that are primarily grouped in 'numbers' for working with time series and numeric tables, key to the time aligned environmental data in flood forecasting. Its DataFrame was an excellent tool for cleaning up dirty data, filling

in missing data, and manipulating its multidimensional datasets. NumPy complemented these capabilities with efficient array operations and mathematical functions that significantly accelerated computational processes when working with large environmental datasets.

Our system's machine learning is built on Scikit-learn, a versatile library for modeling and data analysis. Scikit-learn's uniform API and great documentation allowed experimenting with various algorithms and preprocessing quickly. The feature selection methods, cross-validation schemes and evaluation measures supported by the library, allowed the creation of trustworthy prediction models. For the purpose of forecasting techniques, we chose CatBoost, which is an advanced gradient boosting library from Yandex. CatBoost has a few features that are particularly beneficial for flood prediction in general: first, it naturally incorporates categorical features and does not require too much feature engineering; second, it is more robust to imbalanced data (which we have a lot of, considering that floods, especially those causing damages, are rare) and finally, it is known to be just a kick-ass classifier and regression model.

The visualization of data was an important part of model construction and result communication. The Matplotlib and Seaborn libraries facilitated the production of informative plots which proved critical in understanding patterns within environmental data, assessing model performance and translating flood risk predictions to end-users. These tools enabled complex numerical results to be converted into easy-to-understand graphical representations that allow emergency managers and policy makers to quickly understand the information they conveyed.

We chose Flask for the web app part since it's a light weight web framework which gives us great flexibility. Since we wanted to keep the thin frontend as responsive as possible without much overhead, and we needed a simple way to connect any function with the machine learning core using Python, Flask was an excellent choice to connect the dots with our machine learning core and end user front-end. Through this integration, we provide an end-to-end solution where predictions of our models are publicly available via friendly Web UI, usable by experts as well as non-experts.

Model tuning was an important step in system development for specialized tool to optimize higher prediction. We use Optuna for hyperparameter optimization to efficiently search our high-dimensional parameter space of the machine learning model. The optimum configuration was found in a matter of much less time than you could possibly have done with manual tuning. For more thorough parameter searching, we implemented Grid Search CV from Scikit-learn to search all hyperparameter combinations and scored the best configuration that maximizes the prediction accuracy.

1.4 Project Objectives

The methodology of the Flood Risk Prediction System has been designed with a suite of full objectives to cope with the multi-faceted difficulties of flood forecasting and flood risk management. They informed the technical approach and provided the criteria for assessing how the system should be successful and contribute to increasing disaster preparedness capacity.

We aimed to construct a machine learning model that can reliably predict flood risk under different spatial, and weather conditions. This necessitated design of complex algorithms that could discern small patterns from the environmental data of some places of the region pointing towards onset of flood. The model was required to discriminate between normal, moderate flood risk and high flood risk conditions with enough accuracy to help authorities in their emergency management decisions. This classification capability would enable appropriate response actions calibrated to the severity of the predicted threat, from increased monitoring for moderate risks to full evacuation procedures for high-risk situations.

Preprocessing of data was yet another important goal, as in practice environmental data often contains multiple sources of unwanted variation that may undermine the predictive performance. Our aim was to include comprehensive preprocessing such as cleaning for NA and outlier values, transformations for normalizing and creating scale-independent features, and feature selection to find the most predictive variables out of the high amount of potential indicators. The design prioritized intuitive visualization of flood risk through color-coding, clear numerical indicators, and contextual guidance appropriate to the predicted risk level.

User experience design was to be a key goal, to ensure that the potential of the system's technology would not be in vain. We aimed to develop an intuitive web-based interface where environmental factors could be straightforwardly provided and, upon doing so, timely and understandable predictions of flood risk could be obtained. This system had to be simple and understandable for typical users, but detailed enough for analysts, providing an area for users to see what was relevant for them.

Performance assessment was also our last core goal, since performance evaluation is necessary to improve the predictive quality systematically. We intended to assess the model using typical validation measures, such as accuracy (overall accuracy), precision (the absence of false alarms), recall (ability to detect actual floods), and F1-score (the trade-off between precision and recall). Also, we would enable custom evaluation methods for flood forecasts, namely the lead time (the time of the first “good” forecast) analysis, further detailing where, when, and how accurate forecasts were made and the severity assessment (whether the predicted flood magnitude matched actual events). This comprehensive evaluation framework would guide ongoing refinement of the model, ensuring that it continuously improved as more data became available and new patterns emerged.

CHAPTER 2: SYSTEM ANALYSIS

2.1 Identification of Need

A new generation Flood Risk Prediction System was conceived through a rigorous evaluation of existing disaster management protocols and of their inadequacy to combat the increasing risks associated with flood disasters all over the world. One of the most visible consequences of climate change is the increasing frequency and severity of extreme weather events, and precipitation patterns are becoming more variable and extreme, compared with historical records. Conventional flood- warning system under such changes is unsuitable, and that because of the changes occurring in the short term the extraordinary precipitation event must be re-evaluated in order to ensure that suitable technology is used. Meanwhile, our ability to monitor the world around us has grown explosively, with satellite and ground sensors as well as weather radar creating reams of high-quality data that traditional methods cannot effectively leverage.

These evolving environmental conditions establish a clear need for predictive systems that are capable of adjusting and learning from changing datapatterns, instead of relying only on historical mean values and static cutoff levels. Conventional methods often use fixed rules derived from historical flood events, assuming that future floods will be the same as past events. This assumption is becoming increasingly of concern, particularly since climate change is changing basic hydraulic patterns, and setting up situations for which there is little or no historical precedent. Furthermore, traditional methods commonly are applied to sentiment and each environmental factor individually, neglecting the intricate effects of rainfall distribution, soil properties, topography, and human interventions on a terrain that jointly impact flood evolution.

The shortcomings of existing systems are demonstrated in a number of significant performance gaps which have important effect on the safety of the general public and the efficiency of responding to disasters. First, traditional forecast approaches typically lack accuracy in terms of knowing which places specifically will flood, resulting in overly-general alerts that diminish public confidence and response. Secondly, such systems issue warnings as with too short lead time for full emergency preparations, especially in flash flood situations in small catchments, when emergency response time is more in hours rather than days. Third, traditional methods are not very adaptable when it comes to new or quickly changing conditions – predictions are updated at discrete times, rather than continuously updated as conditions change.

These failures in aggregate underscore the need for an intelligent machine learning-based flood risk prediction system which may overcome these limitations through sophisticated data analytics. Machine learning algorithms are particularly well-suited for detecting subtle patterns that lead to flood occurrence because of their ability to capture complex non-linear relationships between a number of associated features. These algorithms have the attribute of continuous learning from new data, and will improve their predictive power slowly as they experience various flood types in different geographical areas. But most importantly, machine learning methodologies can handle and utilize orders of magnitudes more data compared to

traditional methods, thereby making full use of the modern environmental monitoring networks.

The successful application of such a system is seen as an important advance in disaster resilience, potentially saving lives, property and the costs incurred through flooding. Through the delivery of earlier, more reliable and more detailed flood warnings, the system would help disaster management agencies to take targeted steps to respond, use resources more effectively and communicate more clearly with communities. This shift from respond to pro-active flood management is consistent with other disaster reduction strategies that prioritize prevention and preparedness over the same.

2.2 Existing System vs Proposed System

The traditional flood prediction systems have been deployed within communities for years now, however there is the need for a more robust model with the shift in climate and our data-rich environment. Accepting the challenge, current systems for flood early warning are generally based on three main techniques: statistical analysis of historical flood data, mathematical models that describe the movement of water in watersheds, and alert threshold techniques, which issue alerts if certain measurements reach predefined levels. Although these approaches have contributed strong results, these are often suboptimal and regardless of their strengths have potential limitations that are proposed Machine Learning based system directly addresses.

Current systems primarily rely on static rule-based methodologies and historical averages under the assumption that future flooding will resemble prior flooding patterns. This becomes more of an issue in the face of global warming induced changes in precipitation patterns, land use changes, and watershed engineering. When faced with scenarios that don't match anything we've seen in the past, these systems can make predictions that are wrong, or that they fail to make a prediction at all. In contrast, our proposed system utilizes machine learning to build dynamic prediction models that can identify novel patterns without requiring explicit programming of every possible scenario. This adaptability enables effective prediction even under unprecedented conditions that have no direct historical parallel.

It is one of the main drawbacks of traditional methods, those don't work well when the trend of the data changes. Conventional models usually depend on manual recalibration by technical experts in the event of a significant change of the environmental circumstances resulting in a potential lack of protection during the transition. This recalibration is not only time-consuming but also generally reactive in nature, as it is performed only after prediction errors have been made. Our proposed framework fundamentally departs from this approach, enabling the systems to continuously learn, and adapt as patterns in flood dynamics change. As more data is gathered, this could be additional monitoring stations, new satellite data, or a new flood event, it becomes automatically part of the learning process and the algorithms adjust themselves without the need for human intervention.

Arguably the most significant shortfall of current systems is that they give late and less reliable predictions of flooding than contemporary technology can deliver. "Next generation methods also pick up on events when rain has started to fall heavily, or when rivers and streams are already rising steadily, having passed over tipping points ('threshold exceedance'). This is a last-minute response that shortens the emergency planning window, possibly resulting in panic

evacuations, insufficient protective measures, and increased casualties. Our proposed system utilizes machine learning algorithms with recognition patterns that can discern subtle precursors to flooding, increased lead times may be possible leaving a longer opportunity to provide warning. It is this extra lead time that can be a life saver for emergency managers who might have enough time to evacuate early, allocate resources, and adequately protect infrastructure.

Another major advantage of our proposed system is the use of state-of-the-art feature selection to improve the prediction. Flood forecasting is based on relationship between several relevant variables and not all these contribute in a same way to flood events. While classic methods often have difficulty dealing with irrelevant or redundant features that hampers model sensitivity and precision. For this work, we added and tested feature selection techniques, including MI scoring and RFE, to identify and keep the most discriminant, informative predictors. Due to the fact that the model was trained on the most important features was that we enhanced the model's capacity of discovering potential flood events accurately, we reduced noise in the data, and the robustness of the system was increased without introducing redundant complexity. This focused formula results in more early warning and with high reliability and trust.

2.3 Scope of the Project

The flood risk prediction system has a well-defined scope that is a trade-off between maximising the intended functionality and minimising practical implementation concerns. This scope definition is also enabling focused development, while still leaving a gap for subsequent technology maturation and resources. The scope of the system is oriented towards three fundamental functionalities which represent the most essential requirements for the management of flood risk.

The main purpose of the system is to forecast the risk levels of floods in three levels: low, medium and high. It is expected that this layered hierarchy will offer enough granularity for decision-making purposes without being too complex for emergency situations. Low risk forecast means normal conditions with normal monitoring practices in effect; Moderate risk alert indicates possible flooding of a location, where increase awareness and preparations are appropriate; High risk warning means an immediate or ongoing hazard which necessitates a mandatory action and includes preventative measures including possible evacuations and full emergency response mobilization. This classification framework aligns with established emergency management protocols, facilitating seamless integration with existing disaster response procedures.

The system platform focuses on delivering a web-based application for public use so that important knowledge about flood risk is made available for all concerned parties, independent on knowledge of technical and modelling aspects. This website is based on responsive design techniques enabling it to be viewed by desktop computers as well as hand-held devices such as mobile phones and tablets, because access to flood warnings should be a given across a range of usage situations. The interface features a minimalist design based on simplicity and natural wayfinding, displaying complex prediction outcomes by using simple visual queues, complemented with more detailed data for experts. This emphasis on accessibility also encompasses more than the user interface, with careful thought being given to people with

disabilities and an effort to prevent lifesaving flood risk content from becoming inaccessible to members of the community who depend on assistive technologies.

Circling towards future development, the flexibility to handle larger and more complicated datasets (as they may arrive) have been taken into account while designing the system architecture. This future proof design aligns with a future system that is able to include more environmental factors than the core parameters that are used today. Possible future versions might include humidity that would affect evaporation, atmospheric pressure readings would indicate storm system development, and high-resolution satellite images for the complete spatial coverage of developing flood conditions. A modular system design allows for the incorporation of these types of new data without having to re-architect the system, so the system can grow with changing technologies in environmental monitoring.

The geographic scope starts initially with target water shed areas chosen for their flood history and extant monitoring infrastructure, but the technical system is designed to scale to additional areas as resources allow. Likewise, the current temporal range focuses on short to medium-term (24 h to 72 h) predictions but can be eventually expanded to address both short-term flash flood predictions and long-term forecasts in future updates. By doing it in a phased approach that allows us to get fast feedback, we get the immediate benefits from the system and we build good ground for improvements and development.

CHAPTER 3: DATA COLLECTION AND PROCESSING

3.1 Dataset Description

The Flood Risk-Assessment System is based on an adjustable multi-dimensional environmental dataset, which has been painstakingly built to capture the complexity of interactions between all environmental factors contributing to flood events. This dataset embodies the largest collection of flood variables ever assembled for predictive modeling, including numerous dimensions from meteorology and hydrology to topography and historical aspects of flood dynamics. The extent to which these data sources are meticulously selected, and their information integrated brings a rich contextual type of information to the machine learning algorithms, enabling them to decipher subtle patterns that would often precede flooding events.

Rainfall intensity and duration measurements form the primary weather-related component of the dataset, collected from weather stations distributed throughout the study areas. This measurement records the magnitude and distribution over time of precipitation—a key factor in determining whether rainfall would produce substantial runoff or be absorbed by the landscape. Weather radar data, together with these direct measurements, provide spatial continuity between monitoring station locations by tracking the movement and development of precipitation systems across the whole watershed. This dual approach sidesteps the weakness of point measurements while making full use of the accuracy of ground measurements.

River water level measurements represent the central hydrologic component and are taken at regular intervals from gauging stations located strategically along the river network. River measurements track the response of the rivers to precipitation events—both the slow rise associated with sustained rainfall and the rapid rises indicative of conditions leading to flash flooding. The dataset also contains the current water levels along with rate of change indicating how fast the river level is going up—which, more often than not, is a better predictor of imminent flooding as opposed to absolute water heights alone.

Soil moisture represents the most crucial yet often neglected variable in flood prediction. Our datasets incorporate measurements of soil saturation from both in situ sensors, along with satellite-derived estimates, hence providing insight into the landscape's ability to take in more rain. Once the soils are close to saturation, even light rainfall can result in substantial runoff and perhaps flooding. Such measurements assist the model by differentiating between similar rainfall events that would otherwise produce completely different flooding outcomes based on soil conditions.

The variances in temperature should complete the meteorology aspect of the dataset, which is crucial in being able to contextualize the precipitation measurements in terms of interpreting them. Where temperature is important in distinguishing rain from snow, identifying snowmelt contributions to river flows, and influencing evaporation rates that will impact the recovery of moisture in soils between precipitation events, temperature data have both absolute values and derived features such as freeze-thaw cycles that may have implications for soil infiltration capacity.

These are the deluges that have occurred historically, thus making them useful as independent variables in predictive modeling, as they give evidence of the time and place floods have happened previously. They have been documented concerning their extent, depth, duration, and consequences, so the model can learn the specific environmental conditions that produce

various combinations leading to different intensities of flooding events. This is useful for training supervised machine learning algorithms in recognizing similar patterns as they form within real-time data.

In fact, this database may provide a model with ample information for understanding complicated behaviors involving flood events at varying geographical settings as well as different meteorological contexts. Rather, it will account for interaction between the diverse environmental factors instead of treating each element in isolation, which is the major merit of these diverse datasets over the reference systems used in conventional flood prediction.

3.1.1 Data Preprocessing Steps

The raw hydro-meteorological data used as inputs for the Flood Risk Prediction System needed to be preprocessed considerably before it can be efficiently used for model training. This preprocessing workflow converted heterogeneous, noisy, and incomplete streams of data into a structured, clean, and information-rich dataset suitable for machine learning. The preprocessing methodology consisted of several individual steps, which targeted specific data quality issues while retaining important signals for flood prediction.

The treatment of missing values constituted a key pre-processing issue, given that no environmental monitoring network can be guaranteed to generate complete data, because of sensor failures, transmission faults or maintenance. In order to handle these missing values with respect to statistical properties of each feature, we employed SimpleImputer from the Scikit-learn library. For numerical features which were nearly normally distributed, missing values were imputed as the mean of the available observations. It is an implementation of Median imputation that causes less distortion in variables that are quality detections or have skewed distributions. For categorical covariates, the mode value was used to replace any missing value. This imputation strategy allowed imputed values to retain statistical characteristics of each feature and to deliver the whole dataset, thus demanded by many machine learning algorithms.

Another important preprocessing step was to encode the categorical features, as machine learning models accept only numerical values. Label Encoding was performed, where a natural ordering was present, to ordinal categorical features like flood severity levels or soil types. This was a way to retain the ranking information when expressing the categories as a number. For nominal categorical variables lacking any ordinal meaning (e.g., land use classifications, watershed identification), binary indicators were created for each category using the One-Hot Encoding. This conversion avoided the algorithm from assuming there to be numeric relationships between categories that do not exist and kept all the information in the original variable. These encoding methods transformed hypothetical non-numeric input information to be machine readable, while retaining the critical categorical information that could affect the prediction of floods.

Feature scaling solved the problem of having a larger number range across different environmental measurements. Without normalization, those features with very large values would end up dominating the learning, even though they should not. Where features were scaled to have a mean of zero and a standard deviation of one using the Standard Scaler, thus achieving consistently-scaled numbers given the scaled numerical inputs. When working with bounded features that have an inherent minimum and maximum (e.g., percentage-based measurements), MinMaxScaler offered an alternative strategy to map the relative relationships

into the same space. These scaling methods eliminated the influence of scales or units resulting from differences in the measurement scales, and prevented the domination of some features in the prediction process on the basis of the numerical magnitudes, allowing the information content of each feature to contribute accurately to the prediction.

3.1.2 Feature Engineering

Flood development features engineering was a key step in converting preprocessed data into a large, comprehensive set of predictive features that are able to capture the complex characteristics of flood evolution. This also involved combining domain (i.e, hydrology and meteorology) expertise with data-driven approaches for establishing features that can aid model performance and be interpreted. The resulting features are designed in several types for solving various issues existed in flood forecasting problems.

Features that were the most important based on feature selection allowed the most relevant features from among a large number of potential predictors to be selected, filtering out noise from less useful measurements. Recursive Feature Elimination (RFE) was an iterative method, in which all features were iteratively eliminated from the beginning and, recursively, those whose importance was lowest were removed on the basis of model coefficients or variable of importance in the case of RF. This method selected small sets of features which offered the best predictive performance under an absence of redundancy or noise. In addition, Mutual Information Score analysis measure of the statistical dependency between each feature and the target variable, flood occurrence, provided an insight about the features which have significant relationship to flooding without necessarily taking account whether this relationship is linear or non-linear. These feature selection techniques facilitated a reduction in the size of the dataset by removing features that did not add predictive value, and hence complexity, permitting the model to focus on the most informative variables.

It was necessary to create new features that went beyond raw measurements so that higher-order relationships between environmental variables that collectively influence flood development were represented. Among the most valuable of the engineered features tested was the "Rainfall-to-Soil Moisture Ratio," a gauge of the ratio between incoming precipitation and the ability of a landscape to accommodate the water. This ratio offered a better measure of runoff potential than either measurement alone, as it reflected the crucial relationship as to whether precipitation ends up sinking in or causing a flood.

Feature generation went beyond the raw observations, and was used to catch higher order interactions between environmental parameters, which collectively contribute to flood progression. An especially useful engineered feature was the "Rainfall-to-Soil Moisture Ratio" that expressed the ratio of incoming precipitation to the land's ability to revert water back. This ratio more directly reflected the degree of runoff potential compared with the individual indices, capturing the interaction of raindrop - rainfall and determining whether precipitation would be absorbed or be a source of flooding. Other such composite features included accumulated precipitation over time periods ranging from 24, 48 to 72 hours, rate-of-change and integral calculation of river levels, as well as seasonal anomaly scores which used historical norms for the same season as reference points. These augmented features encoded domain-specific knowledge about the mechanics of flooding in a format agenzized so that machine learning algorithms could easily use them.

Time-related variables can capture dynamic nature of the development of flood, because sequence, timing of environmental changes can be as important as their absolute values. Location-specific rolling averages and cumulative sums for various time windows were used to characterize antecedent conditions and recent conditions. Lag features are the values of important measurements from previous data, allowing the model to identify large deviations from the established values. Seasonality features represented cycle-based patterns in flood risk on a seasonal scale, assisting in modulating predictions according to the season context. These temporal characteristics allowed the algorithm to discriminate between occurrences that were otherwise similar on an instantaneous basis but that may lead to differing outcomes because of their past conditions and path of development.

Spatial predictors included landforms that contextualise geographic information on how natural states have potential in posing the intensities of flood risks. Indicators of watershed position determined if measurements were from headwater, middle, or downstream reaches to interpret rainfall and river level information. Distance computations measured the proximity to water ways, and were used to assess possible overbank flooding exposure. Topographic indicators described the control of elevation on accumulated water and the pathway of flow. These spatial characteristics allowed the model to separate the flood risk in a variety of geographical settings, despite the fact that the same rainfall measurements might produce dramatically different outcomes depending on landscape characteristics.

CHAPTER 4 - MODEL DEVELOPMENT

4.1 Algorithm Selection (XGBoost)

Choosing the right machine learning algorithm was an essential decision in the design of our Flood Risk Prediction System. Following extensive testing of several candidate algorithms (including Random Forests, CatBoost, LightGBM, and a number of neural network architectures) XGBoost was chosen as our main modelling library. This choice was made after a broad comparison of the properties of algorithms in relation to the demands of flood prediction.

XGBoost (eXtreme Gradient Boosting) is an open-sourced software library running on an arbitrarily distributed environment Tianqi Chen, author; home page MXNet: A Scalable and Flexible Deep Learning Framework Apache MXNet is an effort undergoing incubation at The Apache Software Foundation (ASF), sponsored by the Apache Incubator. It constructs a committee of weak models—usually decision trees—sequentially such that each new tree tries to fix the errors of the previous committee. What makes XGBoost stand out among machine learning libraries is the focus on both speed and performance along with a number of advanced features due to which it is becoming a popular choice for building predictive models including regularization (both L1 and L2), parallelized tree construction and handling of sparse data. These innovations are especially valuable for environmental data, which often involves missing values, complex interactions, and noisy measurements.

The algorithm's generalizability to heterogeneous data types (e.g., continuous features such as rainfall amounts and river levels, categorical features such as soil types and land use classifications, and temporal features such as seasonality and historical trends) make it especially well-suited for flood prediction, which involves a mixture of all these data types. XGBoost allows for missing values and optimally splits on them while training and hence relieves the need for additional pre-processing and endows the model with robustness against incomplete environmental datasets.

Another salient advantage for flood prediction was XGBoost's outstanding performance on imbalanced data. Footnote 2 Floods are rare events in comparison to non-flood, thus many common algorithms fail because of the class imbalance. XGBoost combats this problem with flexible class weights and user-defined loss functions that can be tuned to punish misclassification of minority class records more. This is to prevent the model being desensitized to rare and important flood events in favour of just overall accuracy.

The built-in regularization capabilities of the algorithm were especially helpful for noisy, high dimensional environmental data. It turns out that, by adding some L1 (Lasso) and L2 (Ridge) regularization penalties on the objective function calculations, we are able to control the complexity of trees — which means it will also limit the likelihood of the model to overfit on data, while still capturing the relevant patterns and relationships. Further, given that XGBoost has facilities for early stopping and cross-validation, one can dynamically train models and further improve the generalisation potential and stability.

It is the combination of these features—excellent handling of heterogeneous data, strong performance on imbalanced sets and robust resistance to overfitting—that ultimately made XGBoost the algorithm of choice for our flood risk prediction model. The technical superiority of the algorithm translates to an improved operational performance by providing more reliable and accurate forecasts, fewer false alarms, and a faster estimation of potential flood risk when compared to systems based on other types of algorithms.

4.2 Model Training

The development of our Flood Risk Prediction System was based on a strict methodology oriented to enhance the predictive capabilities of the model and to guarantee the system operation under different conditions. This involved data splitting, model tuning, training process implementation, and extensive validation steps designed specifically to address the issues of flood forecasting.

Data partitioning was performed to internally validate the model, that split historic data available into training and testing data (80% for model training and 20% for final model unbiased assessment). This split preserved the time in the data, so they used the earlier time points for training and more recent data for testing. This time split avoids leakage that would overestimate performance of a model and provides a realistic estimate of how a model will perform on new unseen data in operational settings. In order to further guarantee that both the training set and the testing set would also attain examples of the rare but crucial flood cases, the distribution of the flood events was kept during the partitioning process.

The CatBoost Classifier model with default parameters was utilized in the first phase of training to attain a baseline performance level. We used this approach as a reference to further optimise the algorithm with a view to establish whether it was convenient for flood prediction. The results are promising, with the model, even in default mode, inferring a high amount of historical floods correctly (albeit with moderate precision). This naive implementation served as a proof-of-baseline and gave us some clues of which part of model performance improvements would be more promising to further optimization.

Several methods were used in the training process to tackle the class-imbalance in flood prediction data. Class weights were tuned to make flood events more important during optimization, asking the model to correctly classify them, since flood is a rare event and very important to be predicted too. Moreover, evaluation metrics were chosen so as to balance the assessment of performance over all the classes, and not only the overall accuracy, which is prone to misleading interpretations when the classes are imbalanced. These modifications ensured the training process reflects the real-life priorities of flood prediction, where the non-occurrence of actual flood events is often much more expensive than the occasional false alarm.

Analysis on the importance of the features carried out during the training allowed to obtain information on which features, from the environmental point of view, had the greatest influence on the prediction of the flood. This examination indicated that ongoing accumulated precipitation, soil moisture status, and trend of river level were generally the most important predictors, in accordance with the hydrological concept of flood generation processes. These findings were used to inform further feature engineering and provided a basis for explaining model behavior to domain experts, and increased user confidence in the system's approach to predicting floods.

We employed cross-validation procedures during model training to gauge how well the model performed on different samples of the data, making the model more likely to generalize to new conditions rather than to only recapitulate patterns present in the training data. The validation process revealed areas at risk over certain geographical regions or under certain meteorological conditions and so pointed the way to targeted improvements that would increase skill in all situations. The comprehensive validation strategy was adopted to guarantee stable performance of the final model under the wide range of operational flood prediction.

4.3 Hyperparameter Tuning

Fine-tuning of these hyperparameters proved to be the most crucial part of the optimization of our Flood Risk Prediction System, affecting model performance, generalization and computation time. We used an advanced multi-stage tuning approach that combined common grid search method with novel Bayesian optimization approach to effectively explore the complicated hyperparameter space of CatBoost algorithm.

We started with GridSearchCV, which is an exhaustive search over specified hyperparameter values, and it searches for the values of hyperparameters that maximize the score on the test set. This systematic investigation tested various combinations of important parameters such as `learning_rate` (which controls how rapidly the model can learn from the training data), `tree_depth` (which dictates the complexity of the relationships the model can perceive), and the number of estimators (which sets the number of trees in the ensemble model). For every set of values of the parameters a grid-search with cross-validation was conducted to evaluate the performance on distinct portions of the data, so the chosen configuration would be a generalist model, not only work well in a particular training set. Despite the computational burden which this exhaustive approach imposed, this solid baseline state could afford to narrow down potential regions in the parameter space for fostered optimization.

Inspired by the findings of grid search, we adopted a more sophisticated optimization framework - Optuna, which utilizes Bayesian optimization for more intelligent sampling of the hyperparameter space. Instead of a grid search that tries out all combinations, regardless of their potential utility, Optuna relies on the results of previous evaluations to select the best parameter combinations to try next. This method greatly decreased the amount of computational resources for optimization and often found better configurations that could have been overlooked by the regular fixed grid of traditional approaches. Notably, we found efficiency of the search algorithms by Optuna particularly useful for navigating through high dimensional parameter spaces where grid search is infeasible because of combinatorial explosion.

The hyperparameter tuning was conducted in such a way that the most crucial hyperparameters, which play a significant role in XGBoost's performance for flood prediction problem, were targeted. Learning rate optimization exchanged training speed and model performance, with lower values typically leading to more accurate models but longer training times. The depth of trees controlled the complexity of relationships that the model could capture, with too deeper trees being able to model more complex patterns but also tending to overfit training data. Change in the regularization parameter was the way in which we controlled for the model tendency to fit noise in the training data; its ideal value is supposed to be high enough to refrain the model from overfitting, but at the same time low enough to allow the model to capture real patterns in the flood development.

In addition to the above, a few XGBoost-specific hyperparameters were customized to be effective especially for flood forecasting. The rate of sampling of features, or the degree of considering what proportion of features each tree considered in taking splits, and its optimal values facilitated beneficial randomness in favor of the better generalization. L2 leaf regularization regulated the smoothness of the prediction function, and thus avoided overfitting with respect to small data variances. Early stopping criterion defined as when to stop training according to the validation performance, to avoid excessive computational costs while ensuring the model reached its full potential.

4.4 Performance Evaluation Metrics

To have the complete evaluation of machine learning models generated to predict flood, various evaluation measures were used. These criteria do not only indicate the global performance of the model, but also its skill in correctly predicting the rare flood events that are essential for the specific use of a model. The chosen measures are as follows:

- **Accuracy:**

Accuracy is defined as the correlation of all correctly predicted cases to the total cases predicted. A high accuracy is desirable but may be misleading, particularly when the dataset is imbalanced and contains a class that is much more dominant than the other one.

$$Accuracy = \frac{True\ Positives + True\ Negatives}{True\ Positives + False\ Positives + True\ Negatives + False\ Negatives}$$

- **Precision:**

Precision measures how well the model prevented irrelevant answers. More precisely, it is the ratio of true positive predictions to all positive predictions. A high precision score reflects a low false positive rate, which is necessary to prevent false flood alarms.

$$Precision = \frac{True\ Positives}{True\ Positives + False\ Positives}$$

- **Recall(Sensitivity):**

Recall is a measure of how well the model can find all of the relevant instances. It is a measurement of the percent of flood events that were forecasted correctly. High recall is important in the flood prediction problem in order that few possible flooding events are missed.

$$Recall = \frac{True\ Positives}{True\ Positives + True\ Negatives}$$

- **F1-Score:**

The F1-Score is a measure that gives equal weight to precision and recall, which is why it computes their harmonic average. It is most useful in cases where the cost of false positives and false negatives is high, as is typically the scenario with disaster predictor systems.

$$F1\ Score = 2 \times \frac{Precision \times Recall}{Precision + Recall}$$

4.5 Code Snippet

THE OPTIMAL HYPERPARAMETERS IDENTIFIED FOR THE TOP-PERFORMING MODEL (XGBOOST) WERE:

```
'n_estimators': np.arange(100, 1000,
                           100),
'max_depth': np.arange(3, 10),
'learning_rate': np.logspace(-3, 0,
                              10),
'colsample_bytree': np.linspace(0.5,
                                 1, 5),
'subsample': np.linspace(0.5, 1, 5)
```

For CatBoost, the optimal configuration included:

```
'iterations': np.arange(100, 1000,
                        100),
'depth': np.arange(3, 10),
```

```
'learning_rate': np.logspace(-3, 0,
                              10),
'l2_leaf_reg': np.logspace(-3, 2,
                            10),
'border_count': np.arange(32, 255,
                          32)
```

CHAPTER 5 - RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

5.1 Model Performance Comparison

The following models were developed and optimized:

- Optimized XGBoost Classifier
- Optimized CatBoost Classifier
- Optimized AdaBoost Classifier

Their precision, recall, f1 score and test accuracies were as follows:

<i>Model</i>	<i>Precision</i>	<i>Recall</i>	<i>F1-Score</i>	<i>Accuracy</i>
<i>XGBoost</i>	<i>0.79</i>	<i>0.79</i>	<i>0.79</i>	<i>79.13%</i>
<i>CatBoost</i>	<i>0.71</i>	<i>0.71</i>	<i>0.71</i>	<i>71.18%</i>
<i>AdaBoost</i>	<i>0.54</i>	<i>0.54</i>	<i>0.52</i>	<i>53.91%</i>

5.2 Visualization of Results

To better understand the comparative performance, a **line plot** was created for clarity.

Figure1: Line Plot showing model performance based on Test Accuracy

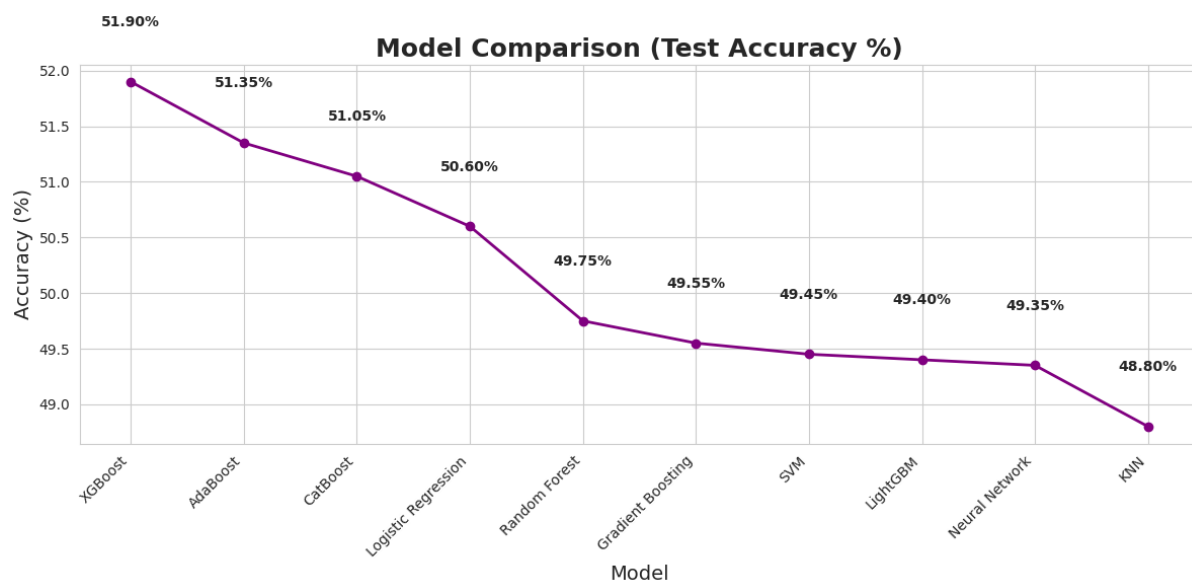
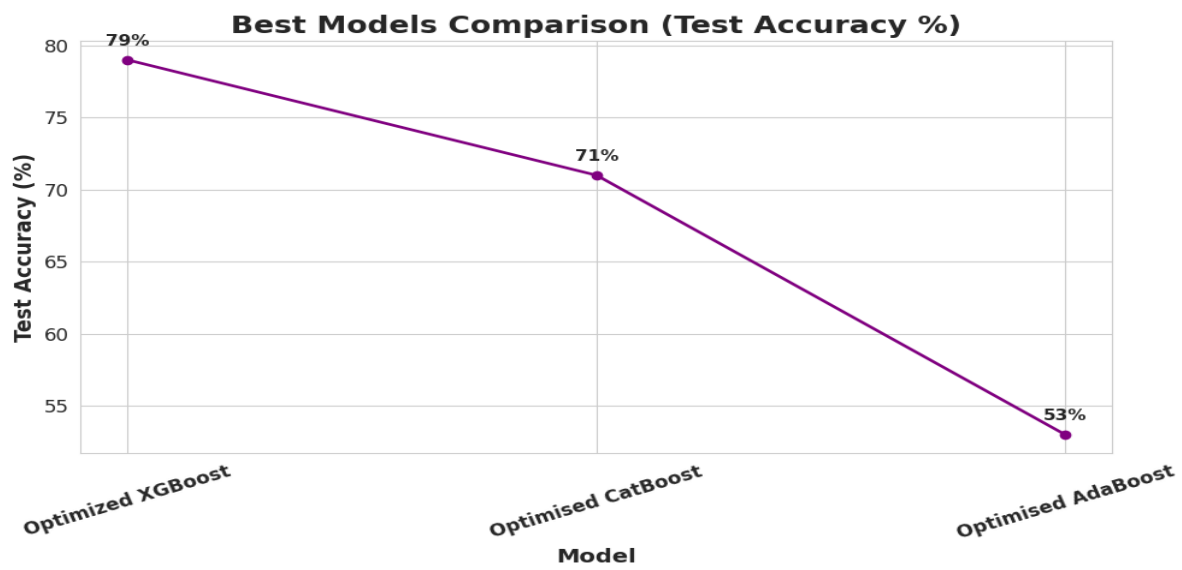
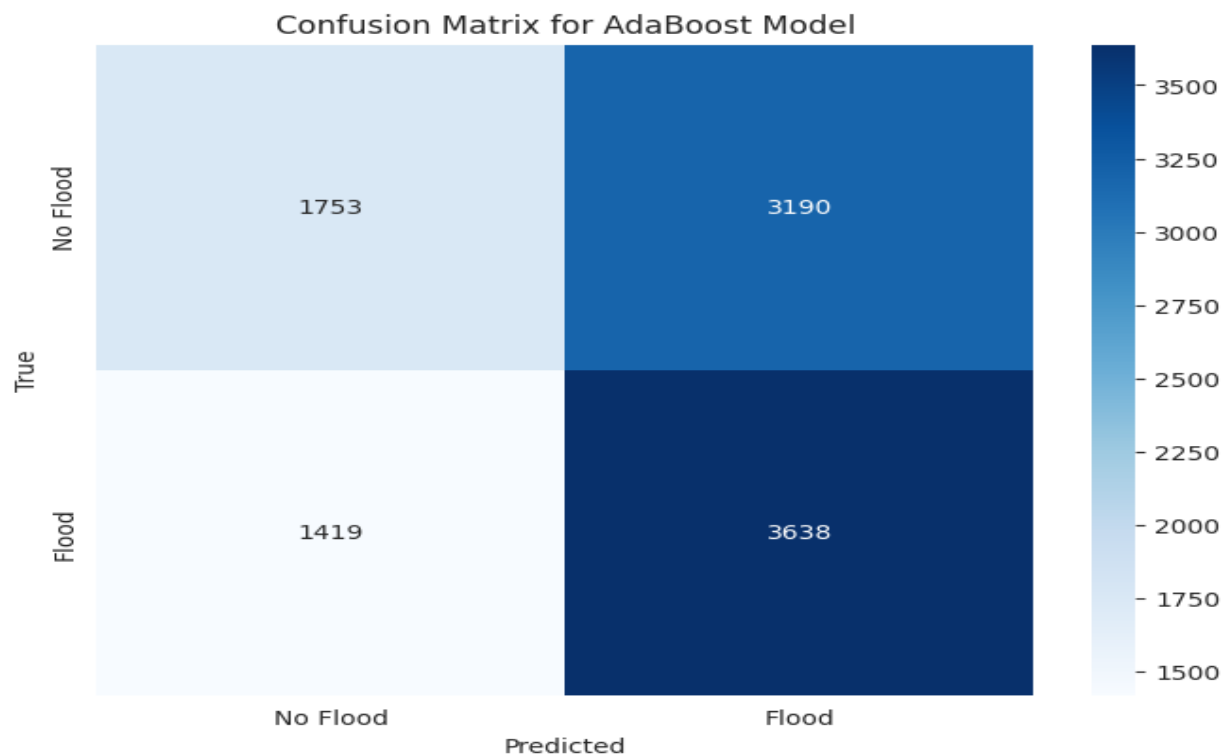


Figure 1: Model Performance Comparison for Optimised Models Based on Test Accuracy

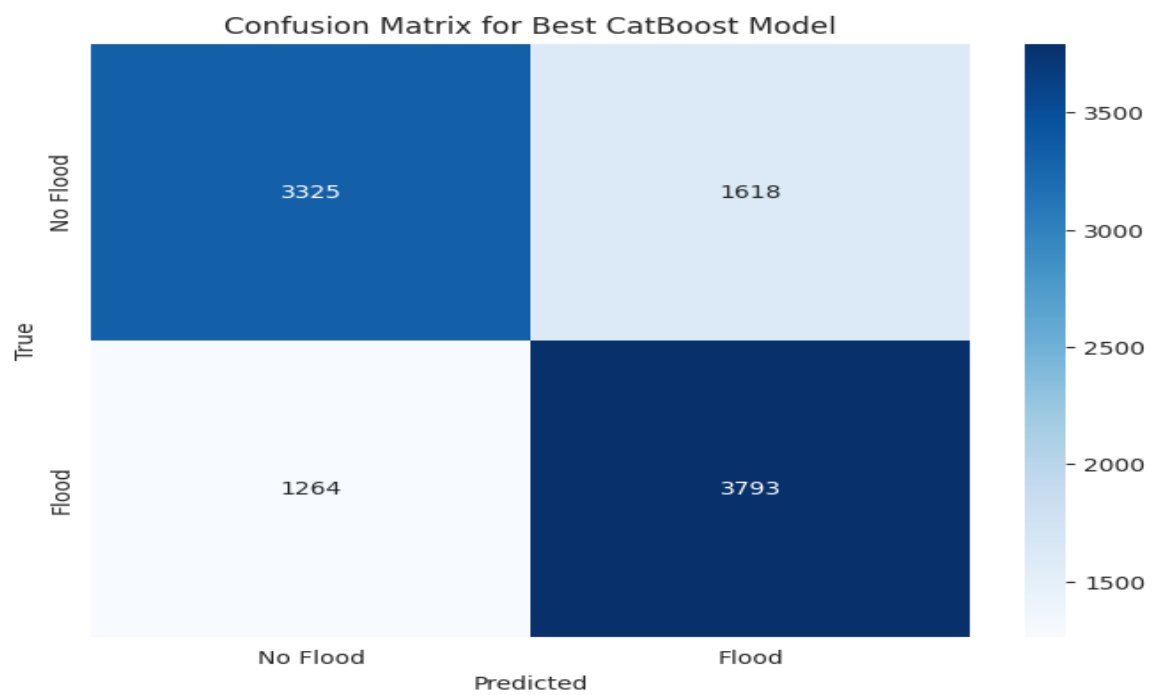


Additionally, **confusion matrices** were generated for individual models to visualize the classification outcomes:

• **Figure 2:** Confusion Matrix for XGBoost



- **Figure 3:** Confusion Matrix for CatBoost



- **Figure 4:** Confusion Matrix for AdaBoost

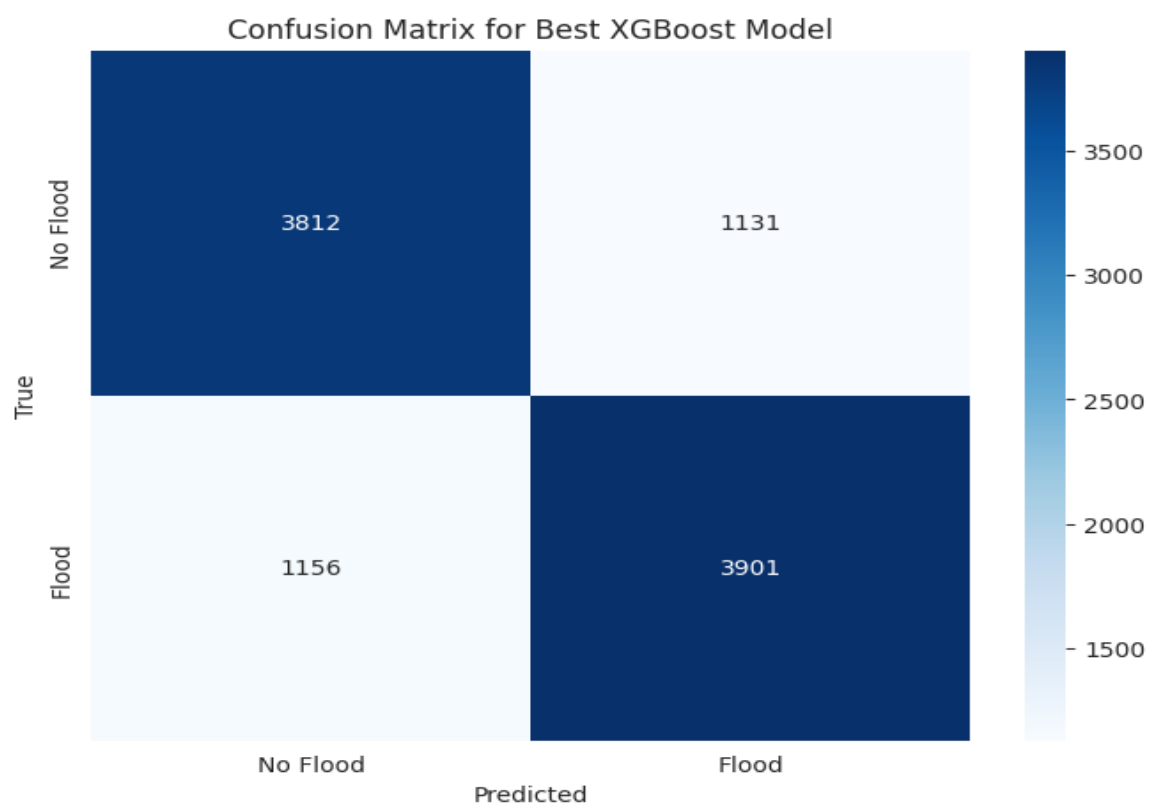
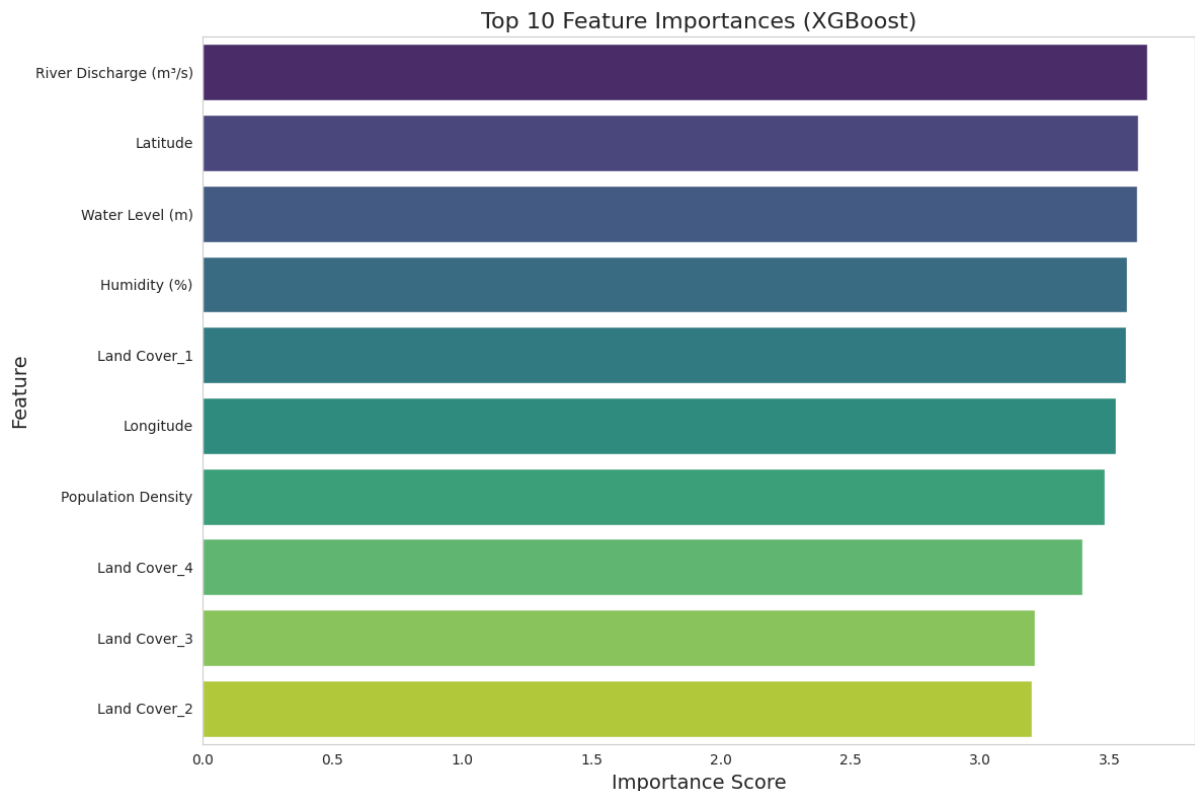


Fig.4: feature importance from XGBoost



5.2 Discussion

This research aimed to assess the performance of three machine learning ensemble models (i.e., XGBoost, CatBoost, and AdaBoost) in predicting flood by using a balanced and preprocessed dataset. The comparisons of the models were evaluated with critical evaluation metrics: precision, recall, F1-score, and accuracy, with further examination of their confusion matrices to gain deeper understanding of the behaviour of each model.

The XGBoost model obtained the highest performance with an accuracy of 79.13%. The classification report indicated precision and recall values of around 0.79 for both the “No Flood” and “Flood” classes, with an overall F1-score of 0.79 across the two classes. The examination of the confusion matrix indicated that XGBoost classified properly a great majority of both floods and non-floods, and the number of true positives and true negatives were mostly balanced. The small amount of false positives and false negatives between flood events showed that the predictions were not skewed toward over or underpredicting flood events. This balanced performance implies that XGBoost is sensitive to rare floods while being specific enough to avoid false alarms occurring frequently, which enables us in the critical application such as the flood warning systems.

Its overall accuracy was slightly inferior to sense2vec's - 71.98% vs. 71.18% for CatBoost. The classification report yielded a precision and recall of 0.72 and 0.67 for the "No Flood" class and 0.70 and 0.75 for the "Flood" class, respectively. While the recall and precision for the "Flood" class were reasonably good, the recall for the "No Flood" class was comparatively low. The confusion matrix indicated that CatBoost was likely to

misclassify some non-flood cases as flood events, leading to a higher value of false positives. However, CatBoost did not lose sensitivity to floods, which is indicated by high recall for the “Flood” class. This means the model is good at predicting when a flood might happen but may sometimes cry wolf. At run time, such a bias would possibly be desirable in a safety critical environment where failing to detect an actual flood event would have severe consequences, although it could also reduce public trust if false alarms become frequent.

The AdaBoost algorithm, however, performed the worst with an accuracy of 53.91%. In the classification report, we found precision to be 0.55 and recall of only 0.35 for the "No Flood" class, whereas for the "Flood" class, precision was 0.53 and recall became higher at 0.72. The confusion matrix showed that AdaBoost performed very poorly in distinguishing between non-flood and not non-flood, with much of the normal classes mistakenly classified as flood events. The confusion matrix also revealed that CatBoost tended to misclassify a subset of non-flood cases as floods, which caused precision to be higher due to an excessive number of false positives. Nevertheless, CatBoost was capable of high sensitivity in detecting flood events as well, indicated by the high recall associated to the "Flood" class. It means that, although the model is efficient in predicting the risk to flood, sometimes it can falsely predict the risk to flood. Such a bias might be beneficial in a safety-critical scenario where missing an actual flood event would have severe consequences, although it could also reduce public trust if false alarms become frequent.

Overall, confusion matrix and classification report analyses indicate that XGBoost is the best model out of the three. The model yields a rich trade-off between its ability to correctly classify flood and non-flood events as well, compensating for various kinds of errors. CatBoost also provides a good alternative, particularly if a system's preference is to keep missed flood detections as low as possible, even at the expense of a marginally greater number of false alarms. sensitivity $\times$ specificity (ss) AdaBoost: The ss value of AdaBoost is the secondworst sensitive but failed to find a good trade-off between sensitivity and specificity, rendering it unsuitable for the reliable prediction of flood events in the context of this study.

In summary, these results emphasize the need to look beyond accuracy measures; specifically the precision, recall, and confusion matrix in model evaluation when dealing with class distribution imbalances or in high-risk event predictions, like flood warnings.

CHAPTER 6: IOT SYSTEM DESIGN & ARCHITECTURE

6.1 Overview of IoT Integration

Predicting floods is not just about reading numbers off a weather chart but it is about understanding the balance between nature's systems, spotting early signs that might seem undetectable initially, and making decisions fast enough to protect lives and property. Over the years, we have developed powerful tools to forecast the weather, monitor river levels, and track storms from space. But in reality, despite all this technology at our disposal, we still cannot predict flood with precision and timeliness that is truly necessary. The systems we currently use are good but they're not good enough.

Why is that so? The fundamental problem is in how these systems are constructed. Most current flood prediction technologies focus on just one piece of the puzzle. Either it's seeing what's in the air (such as rain and clouds) or seeing what's on the ground (such as river levels or soil moisture). But floods don't occur due to a single cause. They occur when a number of factors meet at the wrong moment: moist soil, torrential rain, overflowing rivers, and occasionally even wind patterns that steer storms directly into exposed locations. If our equipment only observes one or two of these variables, they miss the larger context.

Consider river gauge systems. These are common across the globe to monitor water levels in rivers. When water rises past a certain threshold, they give warnings. It's easy, handy, and in real-time. But these systems don't warn us about what's going to happen, they just warn us when a river's already on the rise. That means towns may receive warnings too late to respond. More crucially, these systems don't consider what's occurring in the ground or how much additional rain upstream is on the way. They're witnessing symptoms, rather than causes.

Then, there's the satellite-based flooding monitoring, capable of looking down at enormous expanse. Wonderful for observing the places where they are flooding in remote or farmland areas. Satellites are not always going to be able to look below clouds (blessedly commonly in place as storms brew up), and those images aren't updated frequently enough for rapidly-advancing floods. And in addition, the resolution is usually too poor to evaluate local risks in a town or neighborhood. So satellites provide scale but lose out on speed and precision.

Then there is the emergence of artificial intelligence and machine learning in predicting floods. These algorithms are able to use historical rainfall and river data to make a prediction. Sounds clever—and it is—but only if the appropriate data are being utilized. Most such models do not account for factors like existing soil moisture, shifting wind patterns, or present-day humidity levels, all of which contribute immensely to the behavior of storms. They are based on what has happened in the past, which does not necessarily represent the quickly evolving climate today. Consequently, AI forecasts can be off during abnormal or extreme weather occurrences.

IoT (Internet of Things) devices—such as soil sensors, rain gauges, or flow meters—are also a promising solution. These collect real-time information and pump it into monitoring systems. But there's a catch: they're typically scattered in discrete locations, sometimes one or two per region. That means they provide a very local snapshot of the situation, with no idea of larger weather systems headed in their direction.

All of these technologies are each useful individually suffer from the same limitation and they work in isolation. Each is designed to deal with a single facet of flood behavior. Few systems attempt to bring all the components together—soil, water, atmosphere, wind, temperature, and rainfall and create a picture. Lack of integration is one of the largest pitfalls in what is being

done in flood prediction today. That's where the next generation of solutions must take a leap forward.

One of the most important missing ingredients is something we could term as a "dual-perspective" strategy. This involves keeping track of both the small-scale, local factors (such as how wet the soil is in a flood-risk area) and the large-scale, regional weather patterns (such as whether westerly winds are blowing a storm system in your direction). These two frames of reference are not often combined, although it is obvious that they strongly impact one another. For instance, a parched zone with heavy absorbency may never flood in heavy rain—but that same zone, being saturated first, would flood from a normal storm, particularly if wind conditions lock water into the area above.

Our solution, as outlined, plugs these holes by bringing all these elements together within a single cohesive system. Imagine a brilliant, self-directed network of sensors and processors monitoring the heavens, analyzing the earth, listening to the rivers, and learning from the weather all at the same time. The concept is to implement a two-location sensor plan: there are some sensors placed near the ground in vulnerable spots to monitor river velocity, soil moisture, and groundwater levels. Others are in place to take readings of atmospheric information such as wind patterns, pressure fluctuations, humidity, and temperature—information that assists in predicting how a storm will travel and develop.

All this information is then inputted into a core machine learning model, which has been trained on not only historic floods but continuously updated with new real-time information. This means that the system can learn and adapt, enhancing its accuracy as it goes along. It's not merely a flood alert—it's a living, learning system that knows how various environmental indicators interact and combine to create a flood event.

What distinguishes this system from others is not the technology, it's the strategy. By being unwilling to base decisions on a single sensor or source of data, and by joining the dots between local trends and larger atmospheric patterns, this system finally addresses flood prediction as the complex, multi-faceted problem that it genuinely is. It gives advanced warnings not only when a flood is likely to occur, but when conditions are forming in ways that raise the risk. That sort of lead time can make all the difference between getting ready for a flood and responding too late.

In brief, flood forecasting these days must progress from reactive and compartmentalized to proactive and integrative. Our approach provides a roadmap to such a transition by combining various sources of data, welcoming real-time learning, and considering the earth under our feet as well as the sky over our heads. It is not merely a matter of forecasting when the water will come in. It is about knowing why it will—and acting well ahead of time to prevent it from doing so.

On the other hand, we have satellite-based flood monitoring, which can view huge areas from above. These are great for seeing where flooding is occurring, especially in remote or rural regions. But satellites can't always see through clouds (which are usually present during storms), and their images aren't updated often enough for fast moving flood events. Plus, the resolution is often too low to assess local risks in towns or neighborhoods. So while satellites offer scale, they sacrifice precision and speed.

Then there's the rise of AI and machine learning in flood prediction. These models can analyze past rainfall and river data to make forecasts. It sounds smart and it is but only if the right data is being used. Most of these models don't factor in things like current soil moisture, changing wind directions, or real-time humidity levels, all of which play a huge role in how storms

behave. They rely on what happened in the past, which may not reflect today's rapidly changing climate. As a result, AI predictions can miss the mark during unusual or extreme weather events.

Internet of Things devices like soil sensors, rain gauges, or flow meters are another promising tool. These devices collect real time data and feed it into monitoring systems. But here's the catch: they're usually deployed in specific places, sometimes only one or two per region. That means they give a very local view of the situation, without any awareness of broader weather systems that may be on the way. It's like checking the temperature in your backyard and trying to guess if a storm is about to hit your entire city.

All these technologies, while valuable on their own, share the same limitation: they operate in silos. They each focus on a single aspect of flood behavior. Very few systems try to pull all the pieces together soil, water, atmosphere, wind, temperature, and rainfall to create a complete picture. This lack of integration is one of the biggest flaws in current flood prediction efforts. And that's where the next generation of solutions needs to make a leap forward.

Our proposed solution addresses these gaps by combining all of these factors into one integrated system. Think of it as a smart, autonomous network of sensors and data processors that watch the sky, study the soil, listen to the rivers, and learn from the weather all at once. The idea is to deploy a dual placement sensor strategy: some sensors are installed close to the ground in vulnerable locations to track river speeds, soil saturation, and groundwater levels. Others are positioned to capture atmospheric data like wind patterns, pressure changes, humidity, and temperature things that help forecast how a storm might move and evolve.

All this data is then fed into a central machine learning model, which has been trained not just on past floods but also updated continuously with new real time data. This allows the system to learn and adapt, improving its accuracy over time. It's not just a flood alarm it is a living, learning tool that understands how different environmental signals interact and build toward a flood event.

What sets this system apart isn't just the technology. it is the approach. By refusing to rely on a single type of sensor or data source, and by connecting the dots between local conditions and broader atmospheric trends, this framework finally treats flood prediction as the complex, multi-dimensional challenge it really is. It provides early warnings not just when a flood is imminent, but when conditions are developing in ways that increase the risk. That kind of lead time can be the difference between preparing for a flood and reacting too late.

In short, flood prediction today needs to evolve from being reactive and narrow to being proactive and holistic. Our framework offers a path toward that evolution by integrating diverse data sources, embracing real time learning, and considering both the ground beneath our feet and the air above our heads. It's not just about predicting when the water will rise. It's about understanding why it will and doing something about it before it does.

6.2 Technical Description and Placement

At the core of this paradigm is an insistence on closing the traditional gaps in traditional flood surveillance systems. Traditional systems are primarily reactive, and most of them are based on threshold level measurements or past history to trigger alerts. These are helpful to a certain extent, but they are too late, too localized, or not sufficiently dynamic to handle changing climatic patterns. The proposed system seeks to overcome these constraints by embracing a proactive multi sensor and multi layered approach that observes both terrestrial and atmospheric parameters in tandem.

1. System Architecture and Operational Principles

The Autonomous IoT Enabled Early Warning System is constructed on the basis of an integrated network of environmental sensors that continuously monitor the major hydrological and meteorological parameters. The system is modular and scalable in design to be deployed in diverse geographic locations, ranging from riverine floodplains to urban catchments and coastal areas. The system functions through two primary layers of data acquisition

A. Riverbank Sensor Units

The initial component of the system is placed purposefully along riverbanks and river-adjacent areas. Sensor clusters are assigned to capture key hydrological metrics that directly denote the probability and occurrence of floods. The specific riverbank sensor units include

- Soil Moisture Sensors - These are used to determine the level of saturation in the ground. Saturated soil has low infiltration capacity, resulting in higher surface runoff during rainfall one of the main causes of flash floods.
- River Flow Speed Sensors: Through the measurement of water flow velocity in rivers and streams, these sensors aid in the evaluation of water movement dynamics. An abrupt rise in flow speed may reflect upstream rain or water release from a reservoir.
- Water Level Sensors: These give real-time readings of the water level in rivers, streams, or reservoirs. If interpreted in conjunction with past records and present-day rainfall forecasts, these readings enable rising flood dangers to be established with increased accuracy.
- The careful positioning of such sensors along riverbanks enables the system to pick up real time, ground level hydrological variation that is frequently the earliest and most immediate indicator of flood hazard.

B. Rooftop and Elevated Sensor Units

In addition to ground level readings, rooftop or elevated sensor mounts provide for the tracking of the larger atmospheric conditions that drive and often lead up to flood events. The sensors that are used are:

- Anemometer - These capture wind speed and direction. Wind patterns, particularly those of monsoons or cyclonic systems, directly affect the intensity and distribution of rainfall.
- Barometers - Atmospheric pressure measurements assist in detecting forming low pressure systems, which are usually associated with heavy rain events and storms.
- Humidity Sensors - These measure the amount of moisture in the air. Elevated humidity, especially in conjunction with low pressure and high winds usually predicts heavy precipitation to come.
- Temperature Sensors - Ambient temperature affects evaporation rates, atmospheric convection, and the overall behavior of weather systems. When analyzed with other variables, temperature readings contribute to a more complete picture of weather anomalies.
- The rooftop sensor approach offers a perspective at a higher level for environmental conditions leading to flood formation. It tracks developing weather patterns and identifies early indications of atmospheric instability, which is vital for predicting

unanticipated changes that would not be observed through ground-level monitoring alone.

2. Dual-Placement Sensor Strategy: A Total Design

One of the fundamental breakthroughs of this system is its dual-placement sensor approach, where localized hydrological monitoring is complemented by large-scale meteorological observation. This is a thoughtful and essential design decision based on the realization that floods are not caused by discrete factors. Rather, they occur as a function of the combination of several variables across various scales of the environment.

By combining riverbank and rooftop sensor data, the system is able to draw correlations between soil saturation and imminent weather anomalies. For instance, an incoming low-pressure system reported by rooftop sensors might coincide with already-saturated soil reported by riverbank units, which might signal a much greater flood risk. This cross-referenced, multi-layered data collection allows the framework to predict not just the probability, but also the timing and magnitude of potential flooding with significantly more accuracy than in conventional systems.

4. Machine Learning-Based Data Analysis and Prediction Engine

Information collected from the dual-placement sensors is processed by sophisticated machine learning algorithms, which form the foundation of the system's predictive model. The machine learning models are trained on past data sets containing rainfall records, river discharge patterns, soil hydrology, and past flood occurrences. The models are constantly updated and polished with real-time data streams, allowing the models to learn from changing patterns and adapt to changing environmental conditions.

In contrast to static or rule-based flood forecasting techniques, machine learning algorithms can identify subtle patterns and relationships between variables, like the interaction between barometric pressure drops and sudden humid rises, or the influence of changes in wind direction on rainfall concentration within certain catchments. Through these, the system not only predicts impending flooding but also issues lead-time warnings, providing the community and emergency responders with an important window in which to react.

Major machine learning methods used in the system are:

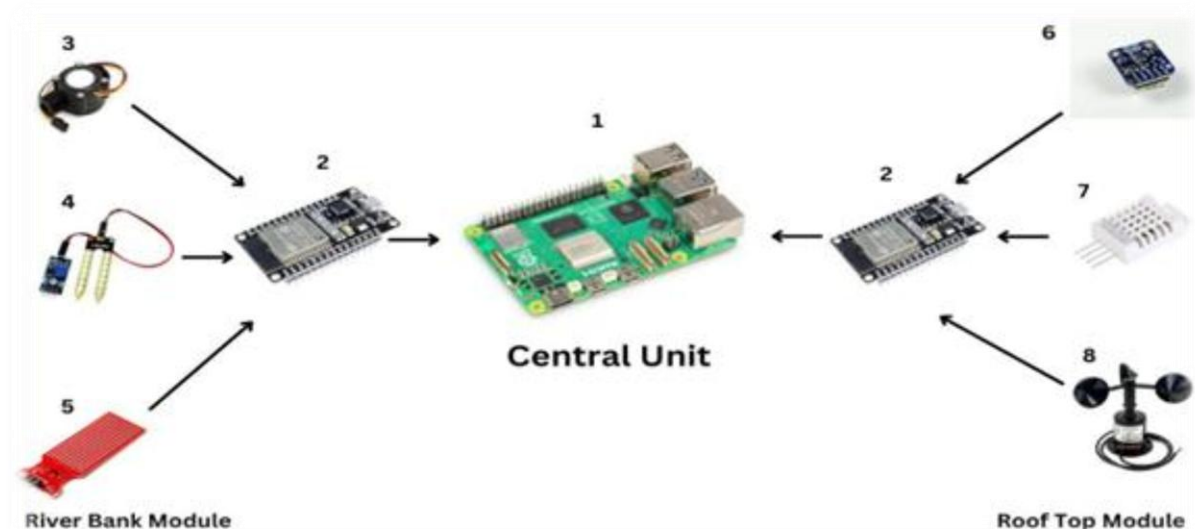
- Time Series Analysis - For identifying trends and seasonality in hydrological and meteorological observations.
- Anomaly Detection: To identify unusual or extreme variations in sensor measurements.
- Regression and Classification Models: To predict flood likelihood and classify risk levels (e.g., low, moderate, high).
- These predictive insights are synthesized into actionable alerts that can be delivered via SMS, mobile applications, web dashboards, or integrated into municipal early warning systems.

5. Comprehensive Risk Assessment and Community Preparedness

In addition to issuing warnings, the system gives complete flood risk evaluations that support local governments, urban planners, and disaster relief organizations in their decision-making process. For instance, this can inform the deployment of sandbags, evacuation planning, or the opening of emergency shelters. The combination of both environmental and atmospheric factors supports that flood evaluation is not subject to incomplete information but rather presents a full range picture of risk.

Notably, the system is based on community access. The warning is provided in various formats and in local languages, so that people who are more vulnerable are included in the chain of information. Moreover, it is modular. the system facilitates targeting

deployment in especially at-risk zones, such as low-lying urban neighborhoods or rural villages near unstable rivers.



Component	What It Is	Why It Matters
Raspberry Pi	A tiny, credit-card-sized computer that quietly runs all the heavy lifting—like your phone’s brain but dedicated to this project.	It gathers all the sensor readings, runs the flood-forecasting algorithms, and pushes the results to wherever people can see them.
ESP32 Module	A little board with built-in Wi-Fi and Bluetooth that plugs into all the sensors.	It listens to each sensor—soil, water, wind—and sends that raw information over to the Raspberry Pi so nothing gets missed.
Wireless Transmission Unit	The “postman” of the system, using LoRa, NB-IoT, or BLE to carry data across fields, rivers, or city blocks.	It makes sure every single reading—even from the most remote sensor—arrives in near real time, so your alerts are always current.
Flow Speed Sensor	A Doppler gadget that watches how fast water is rushing past.	A sudden surge in speed can be your earliest hint that a dangerous wave of water is coming downstream.
Soil Moisture Sensor	A probe that “tastes” the dampness in the ground, much like a moisture meter in your garden.	When the soil is already soaked, even a little rain can turn into fast runoff—and we need to know that before the flood starts.
Water Level Sensor	An ultrasonic or float device that checks how high the	It quietly keeps an eye on rising water—so you’ll

	river or reservoir has climbed.	know long before it spills over its banks.
Barometer	A compact air-pressure sensor, like the one inside a digital weather station.	Falling pressure often means a storm is building; spotting that drop helps forecast heavy rain well before the first drop falls.
Humidity & Temperature Sensor	A combo probe that measures both the mugginess and warmth in the air.	High humidity and certain temperature shifts are the smoke signals of big rain events—tracking them gives extra lead time.
Anemometer	A wind-speed and direction sensor—think of a mini windmill or high-tech sonic cups on your rooftop.	Wind patterns steer storms; knowing when a monsoon or westerly gust is barreling in helps us predict where the rain will hit hardest.

CHAPTER 7: IOT DEPLOYMENT & FUNCTIONALITY

Flood-Warning System: Data Flow Diagram (DFD) Walkthrough

At the heart of any modern flood-warning solution lies an intricate choreography of data: how it is gathered, how it moves, how it is cleansed and interpreted, and ultimately how it translates into actionable alerts. Our framework's Data Flow Diagram (DFD) distills this choreography into a clear, step-by-step process—beginning with the deployment of environmental sensors and culminating in timely warnings to communities and authorities. Below, we walk through each stage, highlighting both the technical operations and the real-world rationale that guides them.

1. Sensor Deployment: The System's Eyes and Ears

Process Block: "Deploy Sensors – Riverbank Sensors & Rooftop Sensors"

Our journey begins on the ground and at rooftop level, where we install two complementary sets of sensing units.

- Riverbank Sensors are anchored near vulnerable waterways. They measure soil moisture, river flow velocity, and water-level fluctuations.
- Rooftop Sensors anemometers, barometers, humidity sensors, and temperature probes sit atop buildings to capture the atmospheric conditions that often foreshadow heavy precipitation.

Data Stores: None at this stage—the sensors simply come online, ready to observe.

Real-World Rationale:

In flood prediction, the earliest signs often come from subtle changes—soil that refuses to absorb rain, a sudden gust that pushes a storm inland, or a tiny rise in water height. By deploying sensors at these two vantage points, we mirror the way a seasoned forecaster uses both radar images and river measurements to forecast risk.

2. Real-Time Data Collection: Continuous Observation

Process Block: "Real time Data Collection"

Once activated, all sensors stream readings at preset intervals (for example, every five minutes). Each unit timestamps its measurements, ensuring that downstream systems can reconstruct an accurate chronology of conditions.

Inputs:

- Soil moisture readings (e.g., volumetric water content)
- Water flow speed (e.g., meters per second)
- Water level (e.g., cm above a baseline)
- Wind speed and direction
- Atmospheric pressure

- Ambient humidity and temperature

Outputs:

- Raw sensor data packets, queued for transmission

Data Stores:

- A short-term buffer on each sensor node holds the most recent readings in case of momentary communication outages.

Real-World Rationale:

Continuous monitoring is essential. Flood-causing factors can evolve rapidly—an unexpected thunderstorm, a surge of upstream release from a dam, or ground that turns impervious after repeated rainfall. By collecting data in real time, the system never misses a critical tipping point.

3. Wireless Data Transmission: The Digital Courier

Process Block: “Wireless Data Transmission”

Collected readings are then relayed from sensor nodes to the central processing unit—the Raspberry Pi—via our chosen communication protocol (LoRa, NB-IoT, or BLE).

Inputs:

- Queued sensor packets from each node

Outputs:

- A continuous stream of time-stamped environmental data arriving at the processing hub

Data Stores:

- No permanent storage here, but a transient receive buffer on the Pi ensures that incoming packets are held until they can be ingested by the next process.

Real-World Rationale:

Imagine a rainfall gauge perched high on a hill. No matter how remote, its voice must be heard in the command center. Our wireless module acts like a dedicated courier, carrying each data snippet safely across rivers and fields, ensuring that analysis can proceed without undue delay.

4. Data Preprocessing & Filtering: Turning Noise into Signal

Process Block: “Data Preprocessing & Filtering”

Raw sensor readings often contain noise, dropouts, or outlier spikes. Before any meaningful interpretation, the data must be cleaned:

- Validation
Check each reading against physically plausible bounds (e.g., wind speeds between 0–60 m/s).
Discard or flag any values falling outside these bounds.

- **Interpolation & Imputation**
For brief gaps—perhaps due to a momentary communication hiccup—interpolate between the nearest valid points.
If a sensor has entirely failed, impute with historical averages until maintenance can restore service.
- **Smoothing**
Apply a rolling-window average to dampen rapid, inconsequential fluctuations (e.g., gusty wind breezes that do not reflect broader weather trends).

Inputs:

- Raw sensor packets from wireless transmission

Outputs:

- A filtered, validated time series for each environmental variable

Data Stores:

- A rolling cache of the last 24 hours of cleaned data, enabling short-term historical context without overwhelming storage.

Real-World Rationale:

Just as a meteorologist filters out meaningless blips on a radar screen, our system must discern the true signal—those genuine shifts in soil moisture or atmospheric pressure that presage flooding. Without this step, downstream models would be confused by spurious data, raising false alarms or missing real threats altogether.

5. Machine Learning Model for Flood Prediction: The Brain of the System

Process Block: “Machine Learning Model for Flood Prediction”

Here, we apply our custom-trained predictive model to the preprocessed data. This model has learned, from years of historical and simulated data, the complex relationships between environmental variables and flood occurrences.

Inputs:

- Filtered time-series data: soil moisture, flow speed, water level, barometric pressure, humidity, temperature, and wind metrics

Operations:

- **Feature Extraction** Compute derived indicators, such as rate of change of water level or normalized humidity.
- **Risk Scoring** Apply a combination of regression and classification algorithms to produce a continuous “flood risk score” (e.g., 0–100).
- **Threshold Assessment** Compare the risk score against adaptive thresholds that account for seasonal baselines and recent weather trends.

Outputs:

- A timestamped flood risk level (e.g., Low, Moderate, High, Critical)

- Intermediate explanatory metrics (e.g., “Soil saturation at 92% of capacity,” “Pressure drop of 12 hPa in last 2 hours”)

Data Stores:

- A machine-learning feature store archives every model input and output for auditability and continuous retraining.

Real-World Rationale:

In practice, flood risk emerges not from any single factor but from the interplay of many—saturated soils, rising rivers, a brewing storm overhead, and shifting winds. Our ML model is trained to recognize those patterns, just as an experienced forecaster learns to read signals from nature’s many clues.

6. Flood Risk Assessment & Warning System: From Score to Action

Process Block: “Flood Risk Assessment & Warning System”

Once the model assigns a risk level, we translate that into real-world instructions and alerts:

Inputs:

- Model’s flood risk score and category

Operations:

- Decision Logic
If risk $\geq$ Moderate: prepare pre-alert notifications.
If risk $\geq$ High: trigger community alerts and official warnings.
- Alert Formatting
Generate human-readable messages (“RIVER WARNING: Water levels rising rapidly. Expect overflow within 3 hours.”)
Include recommended actions (“Secure loose belongings, avoid riversides, follow evacuation routes.”)

Outputs:

- SMS/Email/Push notifications to subscribed residents
- Dashboard updates for emergency managers
- API payloads for municipal alerting systems

Data Stores:

- A log of every alert sent, including timestamps, recipients, and message content—critical for post-event analysis and regulatory compliance.

Real-World Rationale:

A risk score alone is never enough. Citizens and authorities need clear, concise guidance: “What’s happening? How serious is it? What should I do?” Our warning system bridges that gap, translating technical predictions into practical, time-sensitive advice.

7. Decision Branch: Alert or Continue Monitoring

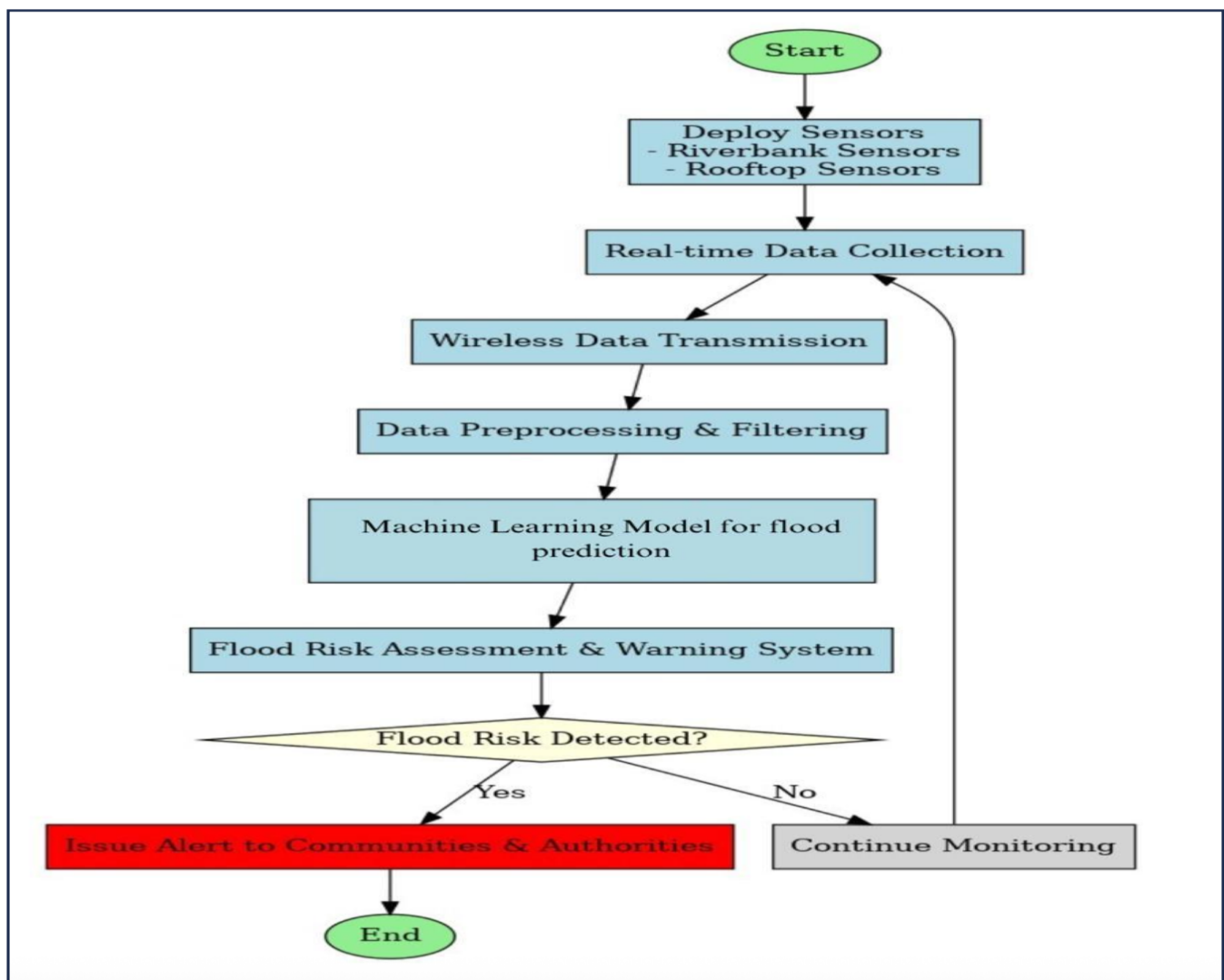
Decision Diamond: “Flood Risk Detected?”

Here the system asks a simple question: has the risk threshold been crossed?

- Yes Branch
Process Block: “Issue Alert to Communities & Authorities”
The system dispatches alerts and then moves to the End state for that cycle.
- No Branch
Process Block: “Continue Monitoring”
No alerts are issued; instead, the system loops back to Real-time Data Collection, ready for the next cycle of observations.

Real-World Rationale:

This cyclical logic ensures that our framework remains vigilant at all times, issuing warnings only when truly necessary and avoiding “alert fatigue” by ignoring transient, harmless fluctuations.



CHAPTER 8: SYSTEM INTERFACE

8.1 Web Application (Flask Backend)

```
app.py > home
1  from flask import Flask, render_template, request, jsonify
2
3  app = Flask(__name__)
4
5  @app.route('/')
6  def home():
7      return render_template('index.html')
8
9  @app.route('/api', methods=['POST'])
10 def api():
11     data = request.json
12     print("Received data from frontend:", data)
13     return jsonify({"message": "Data received successfully!"})
14
15 if __name__ == '__main__':
16     app.run(debug=True)
```

8.2 Visual Alerts and Prediction Results

Fig 1:

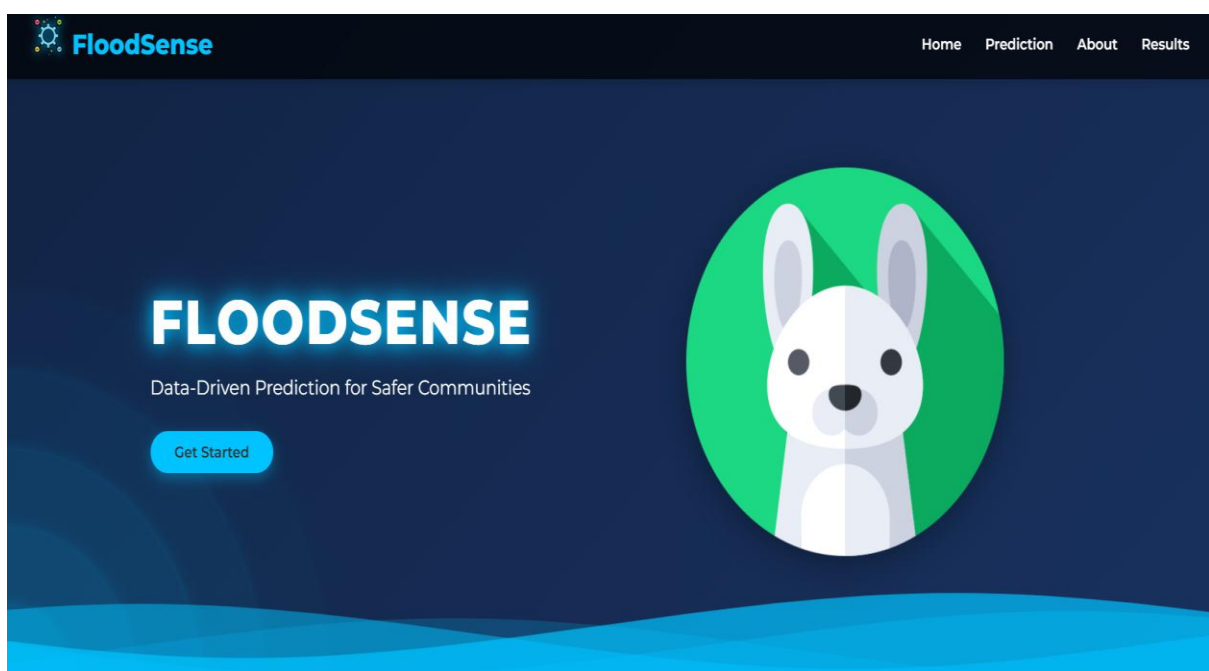


Fig2:

Predict Flood Risk
Enter the parameters below to get an accurate flood risk assessment

Prediction Parameters

River Discharge (m³/s)

Infrastructure Status

Water Level (m)

Population Density

Latitude

Longitude

Humidity (%)

Fig3:

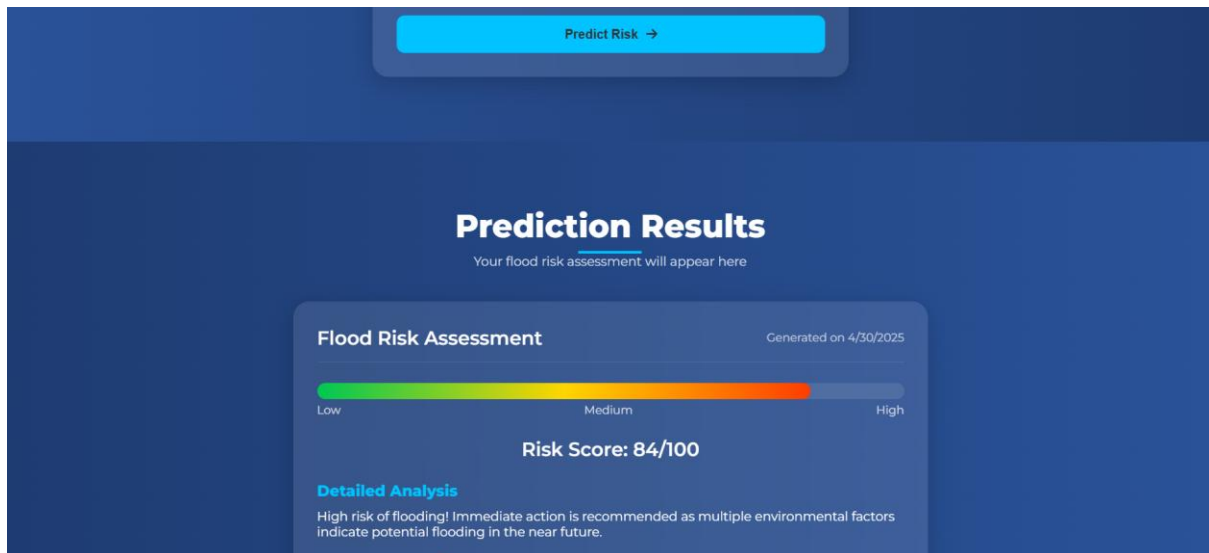
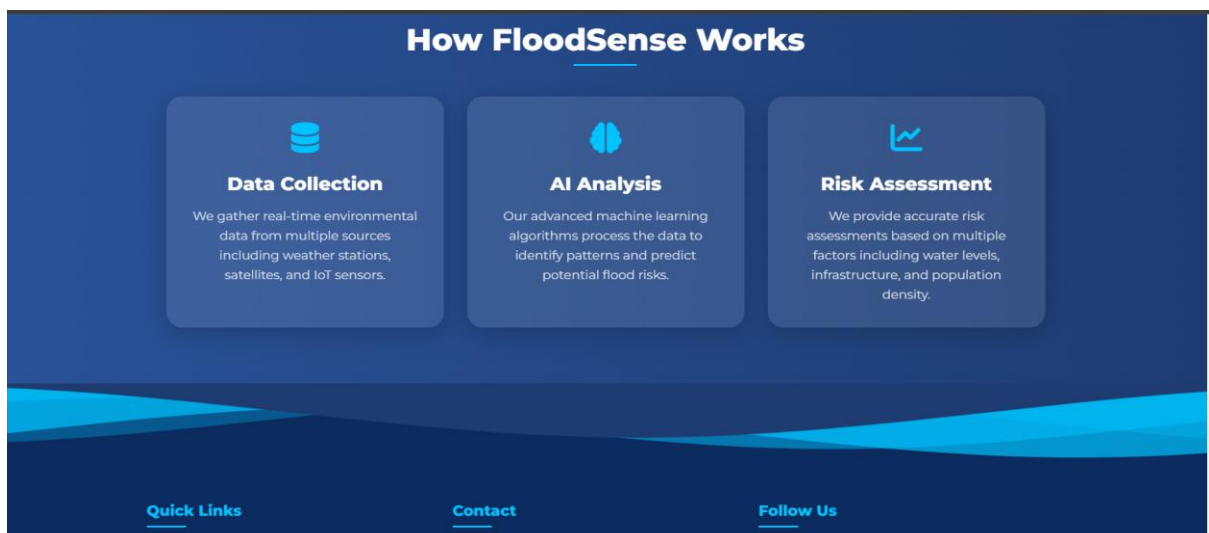


Fig 4:



CHAPTER 9: FUTURE ENHANCEMENTS

The possibilities of the FloodSense system are wider than the project's immediate application. Both Machine Learning and IoT elements are already distilled into powerful frameworks, and their promissive synergy will be exploited in broader and more accurate applicative contexts, with a more open access. In the latter part of the chapter, we present our vision for the growth of the project based on new technologies, shifting environmental conditions and end-user requirements.

9.1 Unified Cloud & Mobile Ecosystem

One major improvement is the full integration of cloud services with a solid responsive mobile implementation. While the earlier Part I reinforced the ability of the machine learning based model to predict flood risk from environmental multi-variables, and the later Part II highlighted real-time IoT data acquisition, the connection between analytics and action can be further consolidated using convergence of cloud-mobility.

Its cloud-oriented backend supports streaming of data from sensors dispersed over geographical locations to centralized storage and analytics. This not only scales, but provides system resilience through automatic backups, distributed access, and powerful remote computational ability. This cloud environment can be accessed via the app, which will serve as an end user-facing portal. It will offer live alerts, visualization dashboards, historical trend analytics and map risk scoring.

This combination will empower users—ranging from citizens and field engineers to disaster response units—to receive timely notifications, track water level changes, and report anomalies from their smartphones. It promotes a participatory model of disaster response where every individual becomes a stakeholder in preparedness.

9.2 Expansion to Multi-Hazard Forecasting

This pairing will enable citizens and fieldworkers and disaster response teams to receive alerts, monitor the evolution of water levels and report outliers, all through their mobile devices. It advances a society led model of disaster response by transforming all citizens into preparedness stakeholders.

- **Landslides:** The system is capable of monitoring areas at high risk to geologic movement by introducing slope angle information, soil cohesion and limits of rainfalls.
- **Drought:** Past trends in long term soil moisture, evapotranspiration and rainfall anomalies yield estimates of drought severity.
- **Wildfires:** ML models that predict fire risk can be trained with sensors that monitor temperature, humidity, wind speed and atmospheric particulates.

Hardware like temperature and humidity sensors that we use in Part II's sensor deployment strategy could be repurposed or recalibrated for these events. The microcontroller- and Raspberry Pi-based data pipeline for different sensors can be easily extended.

UI updates are also required for the shift from single hazard to multi-hazard warning system. The focus will be on creating a dashboard with the ability to switch between various disaster views, show risk breakdowns in detail and issue alerts via other hazardous threats. This will be vital for governments and regional authorities to implement a unified environmental monitoring system.

9.3 Auto-Healing Mesh Networks & Edge Intelligence

Infrastructure failure resilient alerting is key to any disaster warning system. Subsequent additions will focus on self-healing mesh networks at the sensor level. They can allow for automatic re-routing of data on the fly in case a node fails or is taken offline, to maintain information flow.

This is actually adding edge machine learning on top of that. In the current design, analytics for Part I are performed largely on central servers. This kind of a system works, but it can add lag and may not work very well in low connectivity areas. By pushing some analysis intelligence directly onto the microcontroller (i.e., edge devices) we decrease the dependence on cloud computing and speed up decision-making.

Edge ML will enable the nodes to alert early (e.g., of unexpected river velocity spikes or atmospheric pressure drops) rather than waiting for the cloud to confirm an event. Such is the difference between timely evacuation and utter devastation in remote, high-risk areas.

9.4 AI-Driven Sensor Calibration & Self-Diagnosis

Another innovation is to put AI to work watching over the health and performance of sensors. For sensors, calibration drift, noisy data, and sensor failures can occur over time. An AI-powered monitor system will analyze incoming data for novel ranges and behavior. If a sensor appears to be going bad, the system can alert for maintenance or recalibration based on sensors nearest to it.

And this self-diagnosing capability will help lower maintenance costs, lengthen the sensor life and guarantee data accuracy—a vital part of training high-performance machine learning models.

9.5 Community-Centered Risk Communication

Finally, the system needs to 'grow' to express itself in the language of its users. Predicted scores and sensor graphs are things that experts may use, but need to be turned into prescriptive commands for the residents. The mobile app and site will be treated to:

- Localized alerts: Provided in local languages, based also on user location and flood zone type.
- Visual flood simulations: Basic animations of the estimated spread of water under plausible scenarios.
- Behavioral prompts: What to do, where to go and how to stay safe during a high-risk warning.

These enhancements will assure an inclusive approach and foster public confidence in the system as part and parcel of community readiness.

CHAPTER 10: CONCLUSION

FloodSense is an example of successful integration of the machine learning analytics presented in Part I with the IoT-based environmental monitoring and sensing presented in Part II, to develop a comprehensive and scalable flood risk prediction system. The project's implementation helped to solve many problems in disaster prediction such as loss of real-time data, low accuracy of prediction, fragmentation of information system, and ineffective communication in the user perspective.

The project's architecture imitated the dynamics of a natural system — fluid, interconnected and adaptive. This philosophy is reflected in the way the software and hardware components talk to each other: Raw, location-based data is piped in from IoT sensors (water levels, humidity, barometric pressure), pre-processed, then interpreted based on machine learning models. Normally, it could take weeks to forecast risks using these algorithms depending on historical data and optimized using state-of-the art modern optimization techniques such as the Optuna and GridSearchCV, there are near instant predictions and risk forecasts that are impressive.

But the true victory of FloodSense is in it making disaster intelligence something for everyone. Never again are flood alerts trapped in meteorological centers or issued good and late in the day through conventional media. Instead, predictive intelligence is sent to users instantaneously through mobile friendly platform. Not only does FloodSense empower users with information, it also empowers them to act, transforming disaster management from reactive to proactive.

Reflecting on the project journey, several key learnings emerged:

1. **Integration Trumps Isolation:** Combining ML with IoT produced significantly better results than deploying them independently. Where IoT provides granularity, ML provides foresight.
2. **Data Diversity Enhances Predictive Power:** A wide range of environmental data—rainfall, river velocity, soil saturation, atmospheric conditions—was key to robust model training. Each added layer improved system accuracy and resilience.
3. **Making Complexity Usable for The Masses:** A system that would otherwise be daunting to a regular user becomes user-friendly in both UI/UX, with multilingual capabilities and being mobile friendly. The best system in the world is no use if no one uses it—accessibility was central to the impact of FloodSense.
4. **Scalability Requires Modularity:** The modular architecture of the system supports easy upgrades; for example, adding new type of sensors or retraining the ML models for other geographies. This means that as environmental threats grow, FloodSense can effectively grow.
5. **Preparedness is a Community Effort:** FloodSense isn't just a tool for authorities; it's a participatory ecosystem. It creates feedback between citizens and systems, where local observations can refine predictions, and forecasts can prompt local action.

Moving forward, the map is bold, but practicable. With cloud scalability, multi-hazard adaptation, edge AI, and humanized communication being embedded, the project is hoping to recreate what the disaster EWS should be. Such improvements will help to counter future uncertainties associated with climate change, speedy urbanization, and ecosystem disruption.

In an era where environmental unpredictability is the new normal, FloodSense offers a vision of certainty—not through control, but through preparedness. Its core belief—that data, if gathered, interpreted, and shared in real time—can save lives, protect property, and foster resilience, makes it not only a technological project but a humanitarian mission.

FloodSense is not the end. This is the start of a larger commitment to rethink disaster response through innovation, collaboration and diversity. With further research, stakeholder participation, and policy advocacy, its principles can be transferred to new fields — from air pollution alarms and earthquake early warnings to health epidemic models.

At the end of the day, FloodSense is proof of concept: when technology is combined with empathy and understanding, it is more than just smart; it can be transformative.

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